

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #011 — Phase 1, Film 2: Lead, Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

(I KNOW) I'M LOSING YOU

LEAD: David Ruffin • RELEASE: Friday, June 12, 2009

Phase 1, Film 2 • The Incredible Hulk role • Motown Productions / Paramount • PG-13 • approx. 150 min

A. Why David Ruffin

The Incredible Hulk is about a man with enormous power and an “other guy” inside him that he can't control. That other side costs him his place and leaves him on his own. In Motown's history, David Ruffin lived that story for real.

The Incredible Hulk	David Ruffin (documented history)
Huge, raw power	One of the most powerful voices in soul music. He sang lead on “My Girl” (a Hot 100 #1 in 1965), “Ain't Too Proud to Beg” and “(I Know) I'm Losing You”
The “other guy” he can't control	His ego and his drug use
Too dangerous for the team	He demanded top billing as “David Ruffin & the Temptations”, missed a show, and was fired from the group in June 1968
On the run, alone	He launched a solo career and still turned up at Temptations concerts to jump on stage
The Phase 1 film that stands most on its own	A self-contained story inside the Temptations, with light connections to the rest
Tony Stark's closing cameo	The film closes on Berry Gordy, the lead of Film 1

Also considered	Verdict
Marvin Gaye	Not for this slot. His inner conflict is real, but his story is too big for the smallest Phase 1 film, so he gets his own full-strength film.
Levi Stubbs (Four Tops)	He has the raw vocal power, but not the Hulk-like loss of control.
Rick James	His story belongs to a later era (from the late 1970s), outside Phase 1.

B. Release Date: Friday, June 12, 2009

- **It matches the MCU exactly.** *The Incredible Hulk* opened on Friday, June 13, 2008, six weeks after *Iron Man*. June 12, 2009 is exactly six weeks after *Hitsville* (May 1, 2009).
- **It's mid-June.** That keeps the film in the summer season without competing with Film 1's run.

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *(I Know) I'm Losing You*

This is the exact title of Ruffin's 1966 Temptations hit, written by Norman Whitfield, Eddie Holland and Cornelius Grant. The title fits the story: he loses control, he loses the group, and he loses himself. To the public, it's simply a song title (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Otis Williams with Patricia Romanowski, <i>Temptations</i> (1988)	The group's inside story and its account of the 1968 firing
The master recordings, label credits, and the Billboard chart record	Every song, lead vocal, credit and chart position shown on screen
Contemporary press coverage and documented Motown history, 1963–1969	Dates of the lineup changes, tours and releases

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: A preacher's son with one of the greatest voices in soul becomes the lead singer of the Temptations, until the other side of him, the ego and the addiction, costs him everything he fought for.

Act One (1963–1965): Ruffin is a hungry young singer in Detroit. He wins over the Temptations by jumping on stage at one of their shows. In January 1964 he joins Otis Williams, Melvin Franklin, Paul Williams and Eddie Kendricks, forming the “Classic Five.” Smokey Robinson writes “My Girl” for Ruffin's voice, and in 1965 it becomes the group's first Hot 100 #1.

Act Two (1966–1967): The hits keep coming with Norman Whitfield producing: “Ain't Too Proud to Beg” and “(I Know) I'm Losing You.” The group is polished by Motown's artist development, and fame grows. So does the other side of Ruffin: the ego, the drugs, and a growing belief that he *is* the group.

Act Three (1968–1969): Ruffin demands top billing, misses a show, and is fired in June 1968. Dennis Edwards replaces him. On his own and out of control, Ruffin shows up at Temptations concerts and jumps on stage. Then he fights his way back with a solo hit, “My Whole World Ended (The Moment You Left Me)” (1969), which reaches the Top 10. His power is proven again, but the other side is never truly gone.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

David Ruffin's. He's shown at full strength: the voice, the charisma and the showmanship, along with his flaws, exactly as documented. His franchise continues inside the Temptations' story and his later solo career.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	Ruffin's "other guy": his ego and his addiction	The force that costs him the group, just as the Hulk costs Banner his life. This is the film's real enemy.
External	The group-first rules of the Temptations and Motown	The group, led by Otis Williams, and Motown management refused to put one member above the group. They are shown as documented, not as villains.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	1963 to 1969. The fixed points are Ruffin joining in January 1964, "My Girl" reaching #1 in 1965, his firing in June 1968, and his solo hit in 1969.
Where	Detroit (Hitsville U.S.A. and Studio A), plus the Temptations' touring circuit, including New York nightclubs and theaters.
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Two. It starts after <i>Hitsville</i> ends (1961), so it fits on the timeline with no overlap or conflict.

7. Standalone World-Building

- **The Temptations:** the Classic Five, their harmonies, their suits and their choreography, as a complete world of its own.
- **Ruffin's inner life:** his roots as a preacher's son, his signature glasses and showmanship, and his brother Jimmy Ruffin, also a Motown artist.
- **A complete story:** rise, fall and comeback, with a full ending. A first-time viewer needs no other TMU film (40% serialized / 60% standalone).

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in this film
Settings	It brings back the permanent Hitsville and Studio A sets from <i>Hitsville</i> , showing the same rooms years later (Memo #005).
Characters	It introduces the Temptations, producer Norman Whitfield, Motown's artist-development staff and Jimmy Ruffin. Smokey Robinson returns as the writer and producer of "My Girl," played by the same actor as in <i>Hitsville</i> .
Plot elements	Motown's artist development, the Quality Control system introduced in Film 1, and the group-over-individual rule that later films will test again.
The house band	The Funk Brothers return. The Hitsville house band has grown into Motown's full session band.

9. Post-Credits Scenes: None

The Incredible Hulk had **no post-credits scene**. Its Tony Stark cameo was an epilogue before the credits, and TMU copies that exactly. **Closing epilogue (before the credits, 1969):** at a Friday Quality Control meeting at Hitsville, Berry Gordy, the lead of Film 1, listens to Ruffin's solo record and approves it for release. Every Motown release went through Quality Control, so the scene stays true to the record. It's the first time the lead of one TMU film shows up at the end of another. It's shot under sealed security (Memo #007).

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

D. Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Ruffin, the Temptations and every returning character appear at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 1, Film 2 of 6. Released June 12, 2009.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 40% serialized / 60% standalone.
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 150 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The same Smokey actor returns, the same sets are used, and the story is set after Film 1's dates.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a Temptations-era biopic, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The film and the roles here are fictional.